

Tiva Rocco

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[Linkedin](#) | [Personal Portfolio](#)

EDUCATION

North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC

Aug 2025 – Expected May 2030

Ph.D. in Computer Science

Research Interests: CS Education, Software Engineering

California State University, Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

Aug 2021 – Dec 2024

B.S. in Computer Science — Software Engineering

PUBLICATIONS & PRESENTATIONS

CCSC-NW, Willamette University, Salem, OR

Oct 2024

Rocco, T. & Gross, J.B. (2024). Debugging Server- and Client-Side JavaScript. *Journal of Computing Sciences in Colleges*, 40(2), 18-20. [Conference Tutorial]

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

July 2026

LearnLab Summer School, Educational Data Mining Track — Participant

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC

Jan 2026 – Present

Graduate Research Assistant, WISER Lab (Advisor: Dr. Sarah Heckman)

- Conduct CS education & software engineering research

Blackwell Research Institute, New York, NY (Remote)

March 2026 – Present

STEM Research Mentor

- Guide students on reading scientific literature, forming research questions, writing a literature review, and submitting for publication

California State University, Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

May 2024 – Dec 2024

Undergraduate Research Assistant, UROC (Advisor: Dr. Joshua Gross)

- Developed software to engage student learning on computational complexity through visualization of energy consumption and environmental impacts of code
- Served as codebase manager offering debugging support to research team and overseeing workflows

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC

Aug 2025 – Present

Lead Software Engineering Graduate Teaching Assistant

- Lead lab instruction for 60+ students, grade assignments, hold office hours to enhance student development and periodically deliver full lectures

NC State Science House, Catalyst Program, Raleigh, NC

July 2026

AI & Organizational Skills Instructor

- Developed and taught two sessions on using AI for organizational skills, time management, and assignments to 60 STEM high school students with disabilities

California State University, Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

Jan 2024 – Dec 2024

Senior Coordinator, CSUMB TA++ Program

- Offered mentorship and support for new and existing computer science TAs
- Held 3-5 training sessions per semester on TA expectations, ethics, and technical skills

California State University, Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

Oct 2023 – Dec 2024

Web Development Teaching Assistant

- Assisted professor in leading lab instruction, graded assignments & exams, held office hours

Watsonville Tutoring Club, Watsonville, CA
K-12 Mathematics, Reading, & Writing Tutor

Oct 2023 – June 2025

- Implemented curriculums tailored to students' level of knowledge and goals for ages 5-17

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

NC State Helping Hands Project, Raleigh, NC

March 2026 — Present

Mobile App Developer

- Volunteer developer building low-cost prosthetic hands for children, contributing to the complete iOS/Android mobile application from the ground up using React Native and TypeScript
- Built real-time Bluetooth Low Energy communication between the application and an Arduino-powered prosthetic, enabling children ages 7-12 to monitor their device's sensor activity, signal strength, and connection health

NC State ACM Chapter and Computing Success Center, Raleigh, NC

Nov 2025 — Present

Workshop Organizer & Instructor

- Organize and lead GitHub-based personal portfolio workshops, providing free technical and professional development support for computing students

SIGCSE Technical Symposium, St. Louis, MO

Feb 2026

Student Volunteer

NC State Women in Computer Science (WICS), Raleigh, NC

Sep 2025 — May 2026

Student Mentor

- Served three undergraduate and one graduate student, meeting 2+ times per month to discuss coursework, career planning, and strategies for success to support confidence in computing

Community Builders of Monterey Bay, Seaside, CA

Aug 2023 — Oct 2023

Web Development Student Volunteer

- Developed a new site aimed at increasing youth involvement within the community using JavaScript, HTML, and CSS

Life Lab, Santa Cruz, CA

Jan 2023 — May 2023

Web Development Student Volunteer

- Led modernization and updates of the lab's website during a hosting platform migration

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

NC State Graduate School, Raleigh, NC

June 2026

Teaching Certificate, Advanced

NC State ACM Chapter, Raleigh, NC

April 2026

Outstanding Graduate TA Award

NC State Graduate School, Raleigh, NC

March 2026

Teaching Certificate